JOB SEARCH ANALYSIS

Entry-Level Cybersecurity and SOC Opportunities

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1. Career Target and Search Approach

My target career is an entry-level Security Operations Center (SOC) Analyst or a closely related cybersecurity/IT security position. I focused on remote opportunities available to U.S. applicants and positions in the Houston area, a practical regional market to consider alongside Beaumont. The search prioritized alert monitoring, incident triage, security documentation, networking, Linux/Windows systems, and investigation.

The five opportunities below were reviewed on November 13, 2026. Job availability, compensation, work arrangement, and qualifications can change. The employer's application page should be checked again before applying. Where a job-board listing was the accessible source, that is identified.

2. Job Opportunity Review

1. Cyber Security Analyst I — CyberSheath

Location / work mode	United States — Remote
Compensation	$60,000–$83,000 (posted range)
Key qualifications	0–3 years in a SOC; networking/system knowledge; basic query-language understanding; general programming knowledge; Office 365; strong written and verbal communication. Preferred: SIEM/SOAR exposure (Sumo Logic, Defender, Google Chronicle, Azure Sentinel) and Security+, CySA+, or GSEC.
Responsibilities	Monitor client environments, investigate and document security alerts, coordinate urgent incidents, escalate cases, and communicate findings to customers. Rotating overnight weekend schedule is specified.
Fit with my background	Strong alignment with the user's networking coursework, programming background, Linux experience, security projects, and documentation/teamwork experience. Main gaps are professional SOC experience, hands-on SIEM/SOAR and EDR exposure, and a security certification. The employer states U.S. citizenship is required; confirm eligibility before applying. The overnight weekend schedule should also be considered.
Posting link	https://job-boards.greenhouse.io/cybersheath/jobs/5473521008

2. Associate SOC Analyst — Expel

Location / work mode	United States — Remote
Compensation	$85,000–$90,000 (reported in current listing; verify on employer page)
Key qualifications	Current listing describes a remote Associate SOC Analyst opening. Job-board information identifies Linux and cloud platforms (AWS, Azure, GCP) and Spark; 2+ years is described as preferred in the listing summary. Confirm full requirements directly with Expel before applying.
Responsibilities	SOC analysts investigate alerts, analyze security data, and communicate findings as part of a managed detection and response service.
Fit with my background	The user's Linux/Ubuntu background, programming experience, and CyberGuard AI and security lab projects provide a relevant foundation. Gaps include professional SOC experience and deeper cloud-platform and data-analysis exposure. Treat as an aspirational application and tailor the resume to investigation, documentation, Linux, and security projects.
Posting link	https://expel.com/about/careers/

3. Tier 1 SOC Analyst — Binary Defense

Location / work mode	Remote in Houston, Texas
Compensation	Not disclosed in the reviewed posting
Key qualifications	Bachelor's degree in cybersecurity or equivalent experience; 1+ year of security operations or equivalent experience; cybersecurity certification; familiarity with network/endpoint security and frameworks such as MITRE ATT&CK and Cyber Kill Chain; classroom or work experience with SIEM and endpoint-protection platforms.
Responsibilities	Monitor and investigate alerts in a 24/7/365 SOC, triage and escalate malicious activity, perform MITRE ATT&CK/Cyber Kill Chain analysis, document investigations, and communicate with clients.
Fit with my background	The user's networking coursework, cybersecurity projects, Linux experience, and AI alert-analysis project are relevant. However, the stated experience, certification, and SIEM/EDR expectations make this a stretch target at present. Strengthen the application with documented hands-on SIEM/EDR labs and certification progress.

Posting link	https://www.indeed.com/viewjob?jk=68c7ff4c5af7bb5b

4. Jr. OT Cybersecurity Engineer — Jacobs

Location / work mode	Houston, Texas — Hybrid
Compensation	$80,000–$95,000 (posted range)
Key qualifications	0–3 years in cybersecurity, IT networking, systems administration, industrial automation, or related work; related technical bachelor's degree or equivalent experience; TCP/IP, routing, switching, firewalls, and network-security fundamentals; Windows/Linux familiarity. OT/ICS, SCADA, industrial protocols, and standards are preferred.
Responsibilities	Support senior engineers securing OT/ICS and SCADA environments, assist with vulnerability assessments and risk analysis, troubleshoot network/security technologies, document findings, and support preliminary incident investigations.
Fit with my background	This is one of the strongest matches because the posting explicitly considers academic projects and technical training and asks for foundational networking, operating-system, and cybersecurity knowledge. The user's networking, Linux, virtualization, and cybersecurity coursework are relevant. Main gaps are industrial control systems, SCADA, Modbus/DNP3, and standards such as IEC 62443 and NERC CIP.
Posting link	https://www.indeed.com/viewjob?jk=39db8a4b7465bdb8

5. Enterprise IT Security Analyst I — University of Houston System

Location / work mode	Houston, Texas — on-site/hybrid details to confirm
Compensation	Commensurate with experience/education (no specific range shown in reviewed listing)
Key qualifications	The Analyst I listing describes a related four-year degree or equivalent specialized training and at least six months of directly related experience. Confirm degree equivalency, experience interpretation, and current vacancy status with the university.
Responsibilities	Provide day-to-day support for information-security issues, assist with incident investigations and risk assessments, maintain records and procedures, and collect information-security metrics and reporting data.
Fit with my background	The user's expected bachelor's completion in December 2026, networking/security coursework, projects, and technical internship exposure may support a future application. The six-month experience and degree/equivalency requirements need careful review. The university career portal currently surfaces the broadband posting, but the individual job page should be checked for availability before applying.
Posting link	https://careers.uh.edu/jobs/search/uh-central-staff

3. Overall Assessment and Priority

Jacobs appears to be the closest match to my current academic and project background because the posting accepts 0–3 years of related experience and explicitly considers internships, academic projects, and technical training. It values networking, operating-system familiarity, troubleshooting, documentation, and willingness to learn. The main development need is OT/ICS and SCADA knowledge.

CyberSheath is also worth considering because it accepts 0–3 years of SOC experience and offers a fully remote role. However, it asks for SOC experience, SIEM/query-language familiarity, Office 365 knowledge, and U.S. citizenship, and its rotating schedule includes overnight weekend shifts. I should verify eligibility and schedule fit before applying.

The University of Houston System Analyst I role may be appropriate as I approach graduation, but its six-month related-experience and degree/equivalency requirements must be checked carefully. Expel is a promising remote SOC target, although its current listing should be reviewed directly for complete qualifications. Binary Defense is a stretch target because it asks for at least one year of security operations or equivalent experience, a cybersecurity certification, and SIEM/endpoint-protection experience.

4. Job Search Action Plan

• Prioritize Jacobs and other early-career security/networking roles that accept academic projects and technical training.

• Review CyberSheath eligibility conditions and rotating overnight schedule before applying.

• Check the University of Houston System career portal for current status and exact Analyst I requirements.

• Build hands-on SIEM and endpoint-security lab experience before targeting postings requiring Splunk, Sentinel, QRadar, CrowdStrike, or similar tools.

• Prepare tailored resume versions emphasizing networking, Linux, security projects, documentation, and investigation-oriented work.

• Recheck each employer's own application portal immediately before applying.

References

1. Cyber Security Analyst I — CyberSheath. https://job-boards.greenhouse.io/cybersheath/jobs/5473521008

2. Associate SOC Analyst — Expel. https://expel.com/about/careers/

3. Tier 1 SOC Analyst — Binary Defense. https://www.indeed.com/viewjob?jk=68c7ff4c5af7bb5b

4. Jr. OT Cybersecurity Engineer — Jacobs. https://www.indeed.com/viewjob?jk=39db8a4b7465bdb8

5. Enterprise IT Security Analyst I — University of Houston System. https://careers.uh.edu/jobs/search/uh-central-staff

Research date: November 13, 2026. Job listings and compensation are subject to change.